

Abdominal Pain

History

- Time of onset
- Activity at onset
- Description of pain
- Location of pain
- Fever
- Trauma
- Nausea/Vomiting
- Previous abdominal surgeries
- Diarrhea
- Pregnant or of child-bearing age
- Cardiac risk factors
- Gallstones
- Kidney stones
- Medications

Physical Exam

- **Abnormal Vital Signs**
 - Tachycardia and/or hypotension—consider severe pain, infection, shock, cardiac, ectopic pregnancy, AAA rupture, GI bleed
 - Hypertension—severe pain, cardiac
 - Fever – infection
- **Abdominal Exam**
 - Localized or diffuse
 - Abdomen rigid or distended
 - Pulsatile mass
- **Altered Mental Status**
- **Skin**
 - Pale, hot or diaphoretic
- **Hematemesis**
- **Rectal bleeding or dark (black) stools**
- **12-Lead EKG (if available)**
 - If epigastric, diffuse or vague pain and has cardiac risk factor(s)

Emergent Causes of Abdominal Pain to Consider:

- **Cardiac Disease / MI** – Diffuse or epigastric pain, shortness of breath, diaphoresis, vomiting
- **Abdominal Aortic Aneurysm (AAA) Rupture** – hypotension, severe abdominal/back pain, pulsatile mass
- **GI Bleed** – hypotension, tachycardia, pallor
- **Ectopic pregnancy** – hypotension, tachycardia, sudden onset pain, consider in any female of childbearing age
- **Mesenteric ischemia (intestinal infarct)** – hypotension, distended tender abdomen, more common in the elderly

EMT/AEMT

- Follow General Medical Care Guideline

EMT/AEMT - Expanded Scope

- **NS/LR** 500mL bolus x 1 dose
- **Zofran** 4mg IM/ODT for nausea or vomiting
 - May repeat x 4mg in 5 min
 - Max 8mg
- Pain management as per Pain Management Guideline

Paramedic

- 12-Lead EKG (if available)
- **NS/LR** IV/IO 500-2000 mL IV / IO bolus as needed per Medical Shock Guideline
- Consider **Zofran** 4mg IV/IO/IM/ODT for nausea or vomiting
 - May repeat x 4mg in 5 min
 - Max 8mg
- Pain management as per Pain Management Guideline
- Secondary survey and treat any concerning findings as indicated